

Better-Than-McGriddle Sandwich

Maple-pocket griddle cakes · seared sausage · American · basted egg · ~4 sandwiches + a spare cake

YIELD	CAKES	KEY LEVER	GRIDDLE
~4 + spare	9 @ ~58 g	Maple SUGAR	~300°F / 150°C

The whole dish turns on one variable: a maple pocket that survives the griddle. It is solved with maple SUGAR (crystallized), folded in last so it stays as discrete crystals — those crystals melt into pockets of caramelized maple *inside* the cake. **Never liquid syrup in the batter:** it bleeds, scorches against the surface, and gums the crumb. Liquid maple appears in exactly **one** place — the finishing butter, brushed on the *outside* after the cake is set (Component 3, page 2).

1 · GRIDDLE CAKES

Baker's % on flour weight · flour = 100% · ~536 g batter

AP flour — the base; everything else is a % of this	100%	200 g
Maple sugar — structural syrup pockets; folded in LAST, stays crystalline	20%	40 g
Granulated sugar — exterior browning	10%	20 g
Baking powder — lift	4%	8 g
Baking soda — browning + reacts with the buttermilk	0.3%	0.6 g
Fine salt (by weight)	1.5%	3 g
Egg — 1 large; structure	25%	50 g
Buttermilk — tang + tender crumb (the acid lever)	92%	185 g
Melted butter — plain melted & cooled, NOT browned	15%	30 g

MIXING & GRIDDLING

9 cakes · greased 3.5–4" rings · low-and-slow, covered

- 1 Whisk the dry — but HOLD the maple sugar. Combine flour, granulated sugar, baking powder, baking soda, salt. Keep the 40 g maple sugar aside; it goes in dead last.
- 2 Whisk the wet: egg + buttermilk + the cooled melted butter.
- 3 Combine to just-mixed — lumps are fine. Stop the moment the flour disappears; overmixing builds gluten and gives flat, tough cakes.
- 4 Fold the maple sugar in LAST, ≤5 strokes. It must stay suspended as discrete crystals, not dissolve — those undissolved crystals are the syrup pockets.
- 5 Rest the batter 15 min. Hydration finishes and the gluten relaxes — this is the chew.
- 6 Portion + griddle: a #16 disher (scant ¼ cup, ~58 g) into greased 3.5–4" rings, ~1 cm deep, on a ~300°F / 150°C surface. Covered ~3 min, flip, ~3 min. Low-and-slow so the maple sugar caramelizes *inside* without scorching the exterior.

Chew variant: swap 25–30% of the flour for bread flour and bump the buttermilk to ~193 g to offset the higher absorption. More structure, a denser pull — closer to a true griddled-bread bite.

Components & Build

2 · SAUSAGE Your breakfast sausage · 4 patties

Breakfast sausage raw, per patty	80 g
— if leaner than ~25% fat	90 g

- 1 **Smash to ~4" wide** so it sears flat and finishes ~3.5" after shrink — matched to the cake diameter.
- 2 **Sear hard, both sides**, for a full Maillard crust. Melt the American on top **off-heat** (Cheese, right).

4 · EGG 1 large per sandwich · diameter is the only spec

- 1 **Grease a ring sized to the cake** on the griddle; crack in one egg.
- 2 **Add a few drops of water, cover 90 s** to baste-set the top; yolk to preference. The diameter match is what makes the stack sit even.

3 · MAPLE FINISHING BUTTER % on butter weight · the ONLY liquid maple

Butter softened, not melted	100%	40 g
Real maple syrup	25%	10 g
Flaky salt to finish	—	—

- 1 **Beat soft butter + syrup to a compound butter** — do **not** melt it; it must cling.
- 2 **Brush on the cake exteriors during the final 30 s** on the griddle. Outside, post-bake — where liquid maple can't gum the crumb.

CHEESE 1 slice per sandwich · no build

One slice elite-quality American, melted on the hot sausage off the heat. American's **emulsifying salts** give the clean, even melt this needs. **Do not substitute aged cheese** — it breaks and weeps oil.

5 · ASSEMBLY Serve immediately — cakes stale fast once the maple sugar recrystallizes

- 1 **Bottom cake, maple-buttered face up.**
- 2 **Sausage with its melted cheese.**
- 3 **Basted egg.**
- 4 **Top cake, maple-buttered face down.** Close and eat hot.

READ & FIX Judge by the crumb and the pockets — cause → correction

No maple pockets	Maple sugar dissolved into the batter. Fold it in LAST, ≤5 strokes , and griddle promptly — the longer it sits stirred-in, the more it melts. Keep the crystals discrete.
Gummy / scorched crumb	Liquid syrup got into the batter, or the surface ran too hot. Syrup belongs only in the finishing butter (outside); hold the griddle at ~300°F / 150°C and cover so it cooks through low-and-slow.
Flat, tough cakes	Overmixed, or the batter wasn't rested. Mix to just-combined (lumps fine) and rest 15 min.
Stack slides apart	Components mis-matched in size. Smash sausage to ~4" (→ ~3.5"), cook the egg in a cake-sized ring, and stack with the maple-buttered faces inward.
Cheese breaks / weeps	Aged cheese used, or melted over direct heat. Use American , melt it on the hot sausage off the heat .